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VENTURES VOYAGE

August 2025

BUDDING ENTREPRENEURS FORUM

BUDDING ENTREPRENEURS FORUM

BUILD BOLDLY, ADAPT FAST

— your ideas can shape the future.

THE GEN-Z BUSINESS REVOLUTION

NOT BOUND BY RULES, BUT DRIVEN BY PURPOSE —

PURPOSE DRIVEN

DIGITALLY NATIVE

INNOVATION FOCUSED

SOCIALLY CONSCIOUS

INTRODUCTION

With the constantly changing business world, Generation-Z's entrepreneurial drive is redefining the game. Gen Z, born between 1997 and 2012, is rapidly emerging as the most entrepreneurial generation ever.

Referred to as "digital natives," Gen Z is leveraging technology, innovation, and purpose to make their own opportunities, deviating from typical 9-to-5 careers to pursuing businesses that reflect their passions and ambitions.

Armed with tech savviness and independence ambitions, many Gen Z are launching side hustles, establishing online brands, and venturing into the gig and creator economies. 64% of Gen Z want to start their own business in the next three years, as reported in Adobe Survey. In contrast to past generations, who always envisioned success in terms of stability or corporate life, Gen Z sees influence, authenticity, and self-actualization as their success definitions.

They view entrepreneurship as a profession and not just a lifestyle that gives them freedom, creativity, and the possibility to make social change.
Whether it is through green startups, social enterprises, or influencer-led businesses, Gen Z is revolutionizing the definition of being a founder in the 21st century.

This edition showcases how this game-changing generation is transforming the face of business.

SUSHMITA POOJARI
MBA-Finance

ANVITHA KOLLIPARA: INNOVATION THAT SERVES OR THE TRUE POWER OF INNOVATION

In today's startup landscape, where innovation and social impact intersect, Anvitha Kollipara, a Gen Z entrepreneur, is gaining recognition for her social enterprise CareGood. Launched during her teenage years, CareGood aims to deliver solar-powered energy solutions to marginalised communities, particularly old-age homes and rural regions that lack dependable electricity.

Through CareGood, Anvitha has effectively installed solar panels that supply steady and eco-friendly energy to areas that are often neglected in broader development efforts. Her initiative tackles energy insecurity while improving the living conditions of elderly individuals and villagers by fulfilling essential needs such as lighting, fans, and even refrigeration for storing medicines. What sets CareGood apart is its focus on the community. Rather than pursuing rapid growth for financial gain, the organization centers on respecting human dignity and ensuring long-term, sustainable access to energy. By collaborating with local non-governmental organizations and government-backed innovation centers like T-Hub Hyderabad, CareGood has evolved from a school-based project into a widely acknowledged national initiative.

Such start-ups illustrate that entrepreneurship can be about more than just innovation—it can also be about inclusion. Anvitha's journey demonstrates that even young founders can create real change, one solar panel at a time. Innovation is not just about making things bigger, but making lives better.

DEEKSHA PAL
MBA-HR

BUZZ AND BUSINESS:
HOW A YOUNG CEO IS SAVING BEES AND BUILDING A BRAND

Gen-Z is launching purpose-driven businesses at an early age instead of waiting for the "perfect moment" to create something impactful. One of them is Gen-Z entrepreneur Mikaila Ulmer, who turned an early childhood experience into a nationwide initiative. She was just 4 years old when she was stung by a bee.

While most kids might have developed a fear of bees but she recognized the importance to the environment and chose to act. She contributed the earnings to initiatives supporting bee conservation. Her product Me & the Bees lemonade, is now a multi-million-dollar enterprise with a mission available in over 1500 locations throughout the United States.

By the time she was 11, Mikaila had presented her brand on Shark Tank, secured $60000 in funds, and attracted the attention of major retailers; however, this was not a typical lemonade but stood as the story of her goal to help save the bees. What inspires me most is that Mikaila established a mission rather than simply a brand; profit can and should align with authenticity, passion, and social impact, as shown by Gen-Z entrepreneurs like Mikaila.

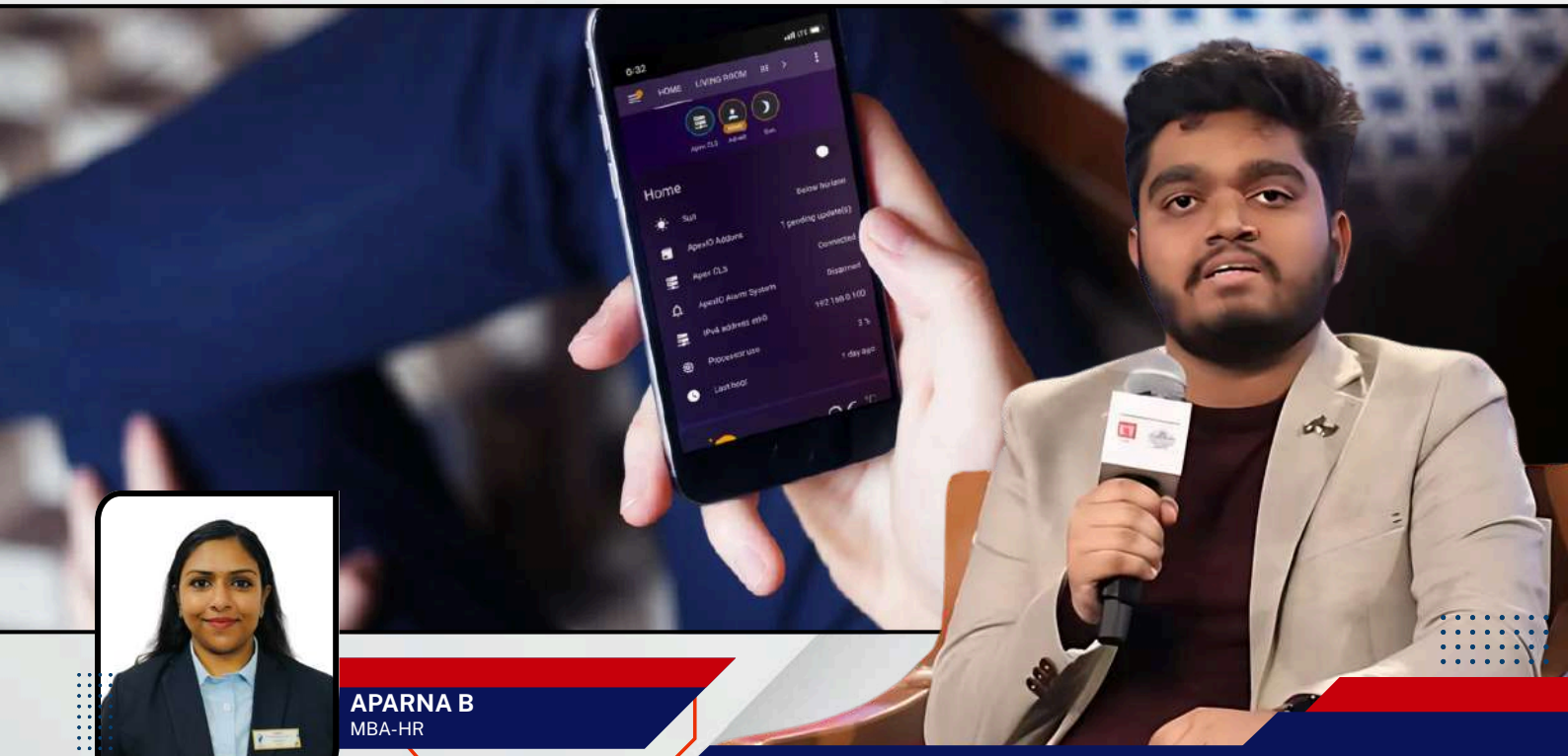
URJA WADGAYE
MBA-HR

ADVAIT THAKUR, YOUNG TECH PRODIGY

At the age of 9, when we were just getting to know about computers, Advait Thakur had already started building websites. By 14, he launched his own company, Apex Infosys India-It is a Global Tech and Innovation company that specializes in IoT-related services and products and is involved primarily in Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning. Apex Infosys stands out as a bridge between innovation and purpose.

One of his early projects, an educational app named Technology Quiz, was rejected by Google five times before it was finally accepted. Imagine facing these many reactions at the age of 14. But eventually he became one of the youngest Google certified professionals and made it to the Top young entrepreneur lists.

What I find most inspiring is how he did not wait for the right age or perfect time. Instead, he started where he was, used what he had, and turned his curiosity into a real venture that created an impact. That is how Gen Z entrepreneurs like Advait Thakur are changing the whole idea of what it means to be an entrepreneur. This generation believes in making an impact by using tech for good. They believe in starting “now.”



APARNA B
MBA-HR

TILAK MEHTA, THE TEEN WHO REWIRED MUMBAI'S DELIVERY NETWORK

Imagine yourself stuck in traffic in the city and worried that your emergency package won't arrive on time, only to have your teenage courier promise you that it will. Tilak Mehta built that universe from scratch. Tilak, then just 13 years old, noticed a chance to shake up Mumbai's dysfunctional distribution network, and his answer not only caught people's attention but also set a new standard for the business.

So, what made Tilak unique in an industry dominated by industry giants? He didn't attempt to bypass the problem with cash. Instead, he recognized the unmatched reliability of Mumbai's dabbawallas, who have mastered navigating every street and rail line daily. By digitizing, Tilak founded Papers N Parcels, a company owned by people already familiar with owning the city and providing same-day delivery at an unmatchable price.

All decisions were made with simplicity and speed, not only size. Customers were reassured by the tracking of parcels in real time. Electronic feedback loops powered innovations. Most importantly, Tilak invested in the dabbawallas themselves by bringing local knowledge together with technological know-how; thus, everyone felt valued and noticed, including his partners and staff.

What can we learn from his experience? Don't wait for a stamp of approval when you notice an opportunity; instead, reinterpret it, search for allies that others may not see, and build trust at every chance. In this manner, a young lad changed the rules for all, not just playing the game.

SANJANA KASHYAP
MBA-HR

PAPERS N PARCELS™

Swimply
Be Somewhere Happier

MAKING A SPLASH: BUNIM LASKIN'S GEN-Z TWIST ON ENTREPRENEURSHIP

At 19 years old, Bunim Laskin founded Swimply, an innovative idea today known as the "Airbnb for swimming pools." Initially, a simple solution to share a neighbor's unused pool, it developed into a peer-to-peer marketplace in which homeowners can rent out their pools by the hour.

Swimply represents a typical signature of Gen Z entrepreneurship: democratization from ownership to access. Unlike previous generations that focused on building capital-intensive enterprises, Gen Z entrepreneurs are using technology to access shared resources, and value is created through sharing as well as networking.

It's not necessarily the uniqueness of the idea that sets Laskin apart, but the thinking. Gen Z CEOs aren't waiting on decades of experience or massive investment—they're spotting gaps in life, acting fast, and building digital-first, community-driven solutions.

With Swimply, Laskin didn't build a company; he unlocked the world to a different approach to space, to utility, and leisure. And by doing that, he represents a generation that's not afraid to dive into nonconventional ideas—and shake up the boat.

KHUSHI SHETHIA
MBA-Finance

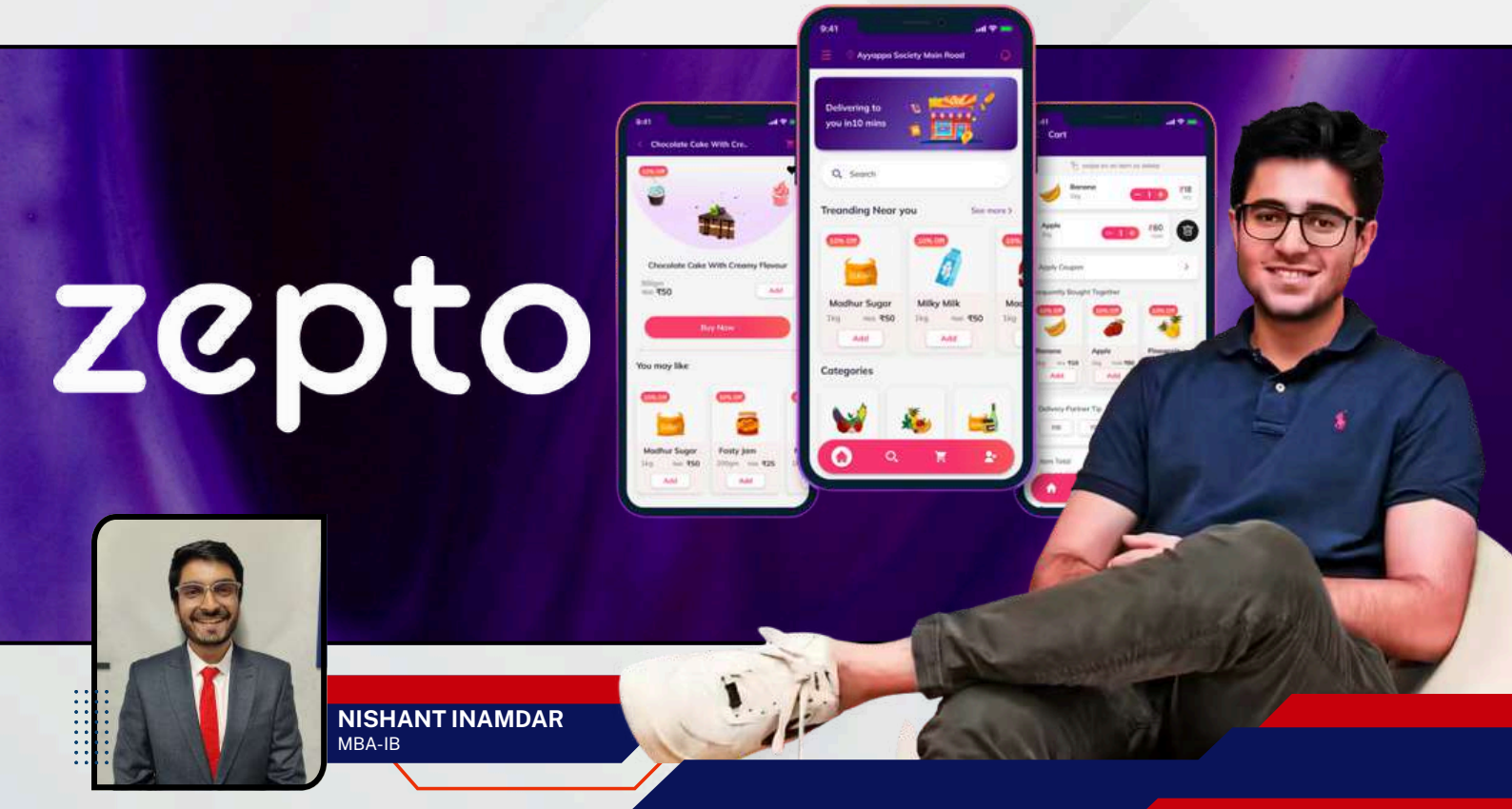
AADIT PALICHA: REVOLUTIONIZING THE DELIVERY BUSINESS, MINUTE BY MINUTE

At 22, Aadit Palicha revolutionized India's shopping experience. Co-founder and CEO of Zepto, he brought groceries to our doorsteps in under 10 minutes. Mumbai-born, Dubai-bred Aadit was an academic ace with a perfect IB score and studied at Stanford before dropping out to start up with his friend, Kaivalya Vohra.

Their journey started with KiranaKart, a hyperlocal delivery platform, which ultimately transformed into Zepto during the COVID-19 lockdown phases. With its dark-store strategy and execution-first approach, Zepto accelerated rapidly - reaching a valuation of $200 million within a month and ultimately achieving unicorn status.

Apart from numbers, Aadit's honest remarks regarding leadership and burnout offer a new perspective within the contemporary culture of relentless push. While detractors debate the role of privilege in Zepto's success, Aadit's keen attention to detail and rapid execution are still to be admired.

In a generation where Generation Z has redefined the norm, Aadit Palicha is among the most compelling examples of ambition, grit, and resilience. And more importantly, as Zepto prepares to go public, his story far from ends.



NISHANT INAMDAR
MBA-IB

GITANJALI RAO: THE YOUNG INVENTOR MAKING A BIG DIFFERENCE

A young American girl Gitanjali Rao, who is a scientist and investor who was named TIME Magazine's 2020 Kid of the Year is achieving incredible things. Gitanjali is busy solving important problems while most of children are only focused on school, leisure and stuck to educational system.

She made a small device that can find out if there's harmful lead in drinking water, something that helps many people stay safe. She also created an app called Kindly that helps stop online bullying using smart technology.

What makes Gitanjali different from older generations is her way of thinking. Gitanjali always believed in starting early and utilising modern technology, such as Artificial Intelligence (AI), to solve most of the problems rapidly in this changing era, in contrast to old generation investors who waited years and always followed drawn out to the procedures.

She focused on actual problems that children and teenagers always deal with on a refund daily basis.Through enjoyable learning sessions, she also imparts her knowledge to other students. Instead of just thinking, she takes action.
Gitanjali shows us that you don't have to wait to grow up to make a difference. Gen-Z, like her, is full of fresh ideas, speed, and the courage to bring change now.

PRIYANKA NAGAR
MBA-IB

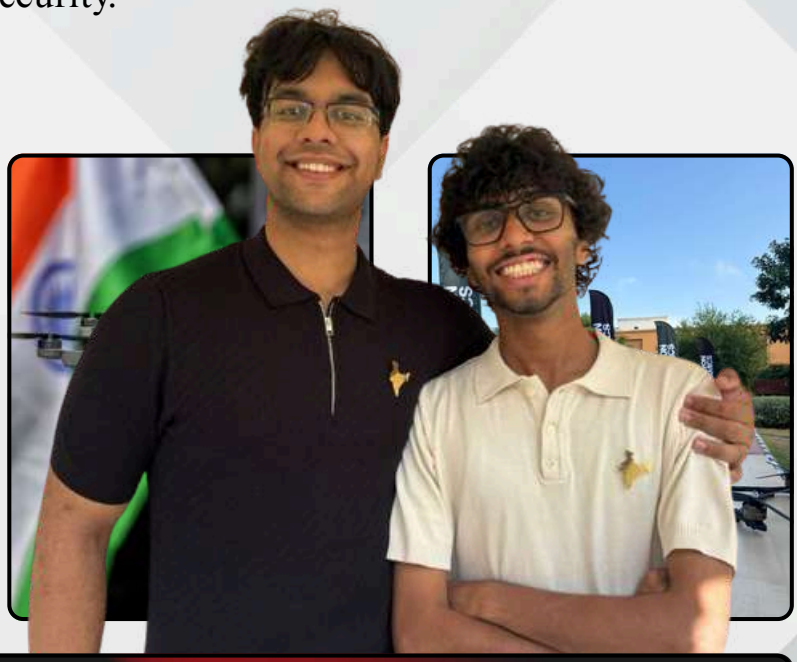
WHAT'S HAPPENING IN ENTREPRENEURIAL WORLD?

1. Apollyon Dynamics

From Hostel to Frontline, Two BITS Pilani Students Revolutionize India's Drone Warfare"

Two 20-year-old undergraduate engineers from BITS Pilani Hyderabad, Jayant Khatri and Sourya Choudhury, have founded Apollyon Dynamics and created high-speed "kamikaze" drones that can fly at over 300 km/h and precisely carry 1 kg payloads, in an encouraging demonstration of India's defense innovation. What started out as chilly LinkedIn messages and store-bought components put together in a dorm room quickly evolved into coordinated demonstrations, and in just two months, the Indian Army issued orders for deployment throughout Arunachal Pradesh, Chandimandir, Panagarh, and Jammu.

Designed for Indian terrain, these radar-evasive combat UAVs showcase low-cost innovation, local development, and rapid prototyping. With support from BITS instructors, their six-student startup is quickly expanding into fixed-wing and VTOL aircraft while offering training for army operators. Their shift from an academic team to a combat-ready unit serves as a strong reminder that homegrown talent can significantly impact national security.



APOLLYON DYNAMICS

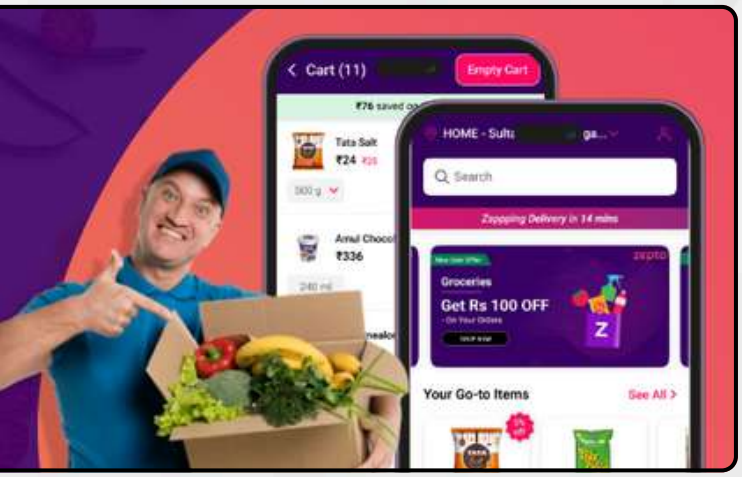
2. Zepto

"Fast, Fresh, Funded, Zepto Poised for $7B Valuation as IPO Looms"

Zepto, a fast-commerce company located in Bengaluru, India, is going to get more money, between $450 million and $500 million. This funding will help to increase the company's value from its expected $5 billion in 2024 to $7 billion, which is a 40% rise. Zepto was started in 2021 by Aadit Palicha and Kaivalya Vohra, who were both students at Stanford University.

The company runs more than 250 dark stores in the biggest cities across India. Zepto is working hard to offer supermarket deliveries within 10 minutes by expanding its network. It is facing competition from companies like Swiggy Instamart, Blinkit, and Zomato's delivery service.

To prepare for an IPO, Zepto is building relationships with Indian investors such as Avenir Growth, General Catalyst, and other regional family offices. The new money will help the company open more dark stores and get ready for going public.



3. The State of GovTech 2025

"Where Innovation Meets City Leadership"

City leaders are meeting at Amazon's HQ2 in Arlington County, VA, on June 17-18, 2025, for the State of GovTech 2025 conference. This event brings together city officials, tech experts, startups, and investors. It is organized by the National League of Cities, CivStart, Technologists for the Public Good, Arlington County, and e. Republic. The conference focuses on new technologies that are changing how cities work and help their residents.

The event is for mayors, city technology officers, council members, and digital planners. It features quick presentations from new startups, discussion-style panels, and talks on AI regulations, smart city systems, data-based planning, and fair city services. NLC experts gave the sessions on using AI with care & responsibly & working together over city departments. They show how technology can help improve government work, even when there are many rules in place.

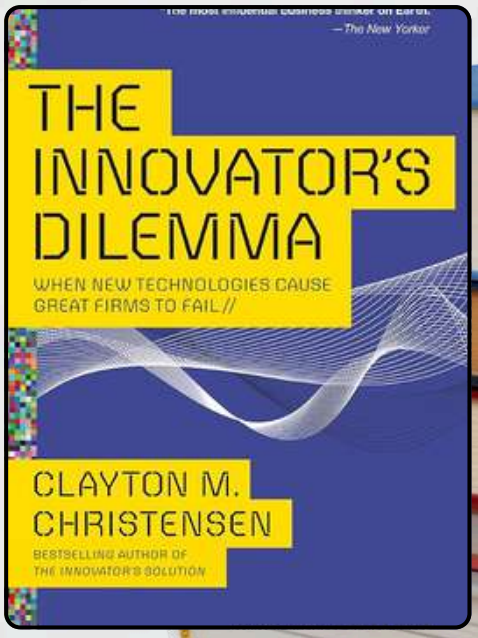
As local governments face growing challenges like managing AI and ensuring fair housing, State of GovTech serves as a space to create new ideas and talk about policies. The conference not only shares stories of successful city projects but also helps officials learn from each other and get the tools and connections they need to try new ideas in their own cities.

DNYANESH PATIL
MBA-Business Analytics

SUGGESTION BOX:
BUSINESS INSPIRATION BOOKS & MOVIES

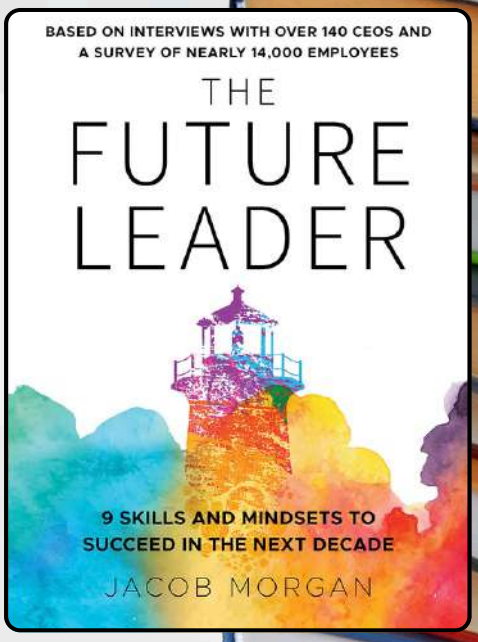
1.The Innovator's Dilemma by Clayton M. Christensen

Even if you are successful and would want to maintain things the same, the book provides insightful advice on how to identify disruptive change and show how to adjust to it. Through his research, Christensen makes it abundantly evident that companies must constantly adapt if they hope to remain relevant over the long term.



2.The Future-Proof Leader by Jacob Morgan

Based on interviews with more than 140 CEOs, the book presents a leadership model that demonstrates how to guide teams through uncertain times with adaptable leadership and compassionate vision that motivates them to achieve success through long-term change.



SUGGESTION BOX:
BUSINESS INSPIRATION BOOKS & MOVIES

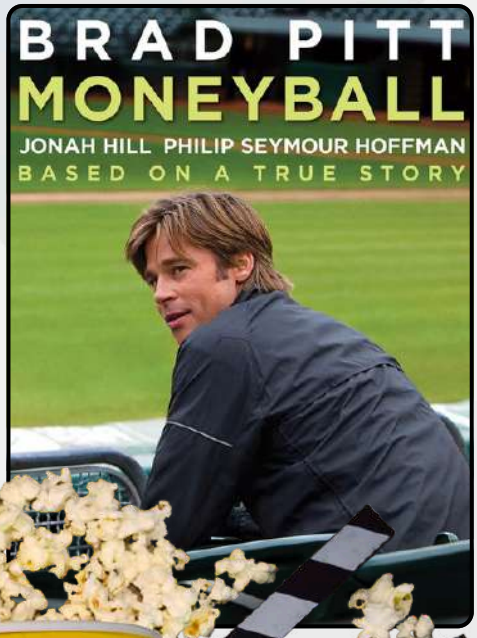
Movies

1. The Big Short

The Big Short is a humorous and entertaining film about the 2008 U.S. housing market disaster. Through witty storytelling, it demystifies complex financial products such as subprime mortgages and credit default swaps. By focusing on a small number of investors who anticipated the crisis and made money, the movie daringly highlights the dangers of complacency, an over-reliance on debt, and a refusal to question the status quo in business and investing.

2. Moneyball

The movie demonstrates how companies can use non-traditional data-based strategies to question accepted norms. The Moneyball story illustrates how companies may use analytical thinking to challenge conventional thought and go from being underdogs to market leaders.



SANJANA KASHYAP
MBA-HR

STUDENT BRANDING HAD NO DIRECTION

Our forum has nurtured entrepreneurial thinking, and the branding team is a reflection of that spirit.
We don't just follow trends — we set them.

With every campaign, we bring bold ideas to life and stay true to our core values: creativity, initiative, and impact. We aim to bridge the gap between student marketers looking to build portfolios and brands seeking creative strategy. With structured roles, SOPs, and real-world accountability, our team is geared to function like a professional setup.

We've already worked with ventures like Encave Café, Riwayat and Createoo, handling everything from digital campaigns to brand identity. This phase brings together years of learning, industry exposure, and access to creative resources—gathered both personally and through our family's advertising business. All of it is now being channelled fully into helping this team grow and giving student marketers the space to thrive.

We're already doing work that might just make even corporate marketers sit up and take notes.

Miles to go before I sleep.

SOHIRA KSHEMKALYANI
MBA-Marketing

CONCLUSION

The stories of these Gen Z entrepreneurs are more than tales of early success, these stories signal a new way of leading. Advait Thakur, Mikaila Ulmer, Aadit Palicha, Tilak Mehta, Bunim Laskin, Gitanjali Rao and Anvitha Kollipara all show how young people no longer wait for the permission or the "the right age" to make an impact. Whether it be creating apps based on AI, helping bees with business, getting groceries delivered fast, or bringing solar energy to rural homes, Gen Z proves that innovation is not just about making money, it is about having a mission.

What keeps these individuals together is the ability to take ordinary issues and turn them into impactful projects through technology, data and swift action. They are transforming traditional methods from redefining access to shared resources, such as Swimply's pool reservations, to enabling social entrepreneurship through access to power, such as CareGood. They contradict the notion that you must have experience first to act.

These young leaders are not tomorrow's leaders, they are today's changemakers. They remind us that big impact is achieved by moving early, thinking outside the box, and making with passion and vision. Success with them is not only defined by metrics, but by the people they reach and barriers they break.
It's not only a moment for Gen Z -its their movement.

VARAD MULGUND
MBA-Business Analytics

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